You

How can I write an email to my IT team requesting access to Employee Self Service and Flex (Timesheets) based on this message from HR:
Hi Hasan, Please could you request access from IT to get set up on ESS and the Flex Portal. Be sure to use your new payroll number: 71098646.

Copilot

Here's a professional and concise email you can send to your IT team to request access:

Subject: Request for Access to ESS and Flex Portal
Hi [IT Team / specific name if known],
I hope you're well. I've been advised by HR to request access to the Employee Self Service (ESS) system and the Flex Portal for timesheets.
Please could you assist in setting me up with access to both platforms? My new payroll number is **71098646**.
Let me know if you need any further details from my side.
Best regards,
Hasan

If your company uses a ticketing system or has a preferred format for access requests, I can help tailor it further. Want to add a bit of urgency or context?

You

(Now Tuesday, Aug 26)
Based on this:
Hi all
Just a couple of things with regards to general house-keeping:

Calendars - please keep your personal outlook calendar and the Application & Systems Support Calendar updated with your whereabouts e.g. leave, working from home, unavailable slots etc
Working from home on one of the usual office days (Tuesday or Thursday). - If you know in advance that you need to work from home on one of these days please email me your request with as much notice as possible, including a brief explanation of why the request is being made. I will always try to accommodate these requests, especially as you consistently provide flexibility and commitment in your roles. I do need to keep a record of why I've authorised any changes to our usual working arrangements though, which is why I'm requesting a written request. I will authorise your request by responding to your email. Once authorised please mark in your outlook calendars that you are working from home.
I appreciate that unexpected things crop up for all of us, and in those cases, just let me know as soon as you can. In these cases a request can then be retrospectively submitted.

Any queries give me a shout.
Thanks

How can I send an email to my manager notifying him that I'll be working from home on Thursday. My reasons are the following:

- There's nothing in-person going on and so I think I would be better completing my work at home, I also don't need to liase with any other team members
- Bus journeys cost me £5 every time I come to the office (both ways)
- I don't have anything else going on that I need to leave the house for so I would prefer to stay at home

Keep the email polite and professional and rephrase those reasons that I said according to this tone, keep in mind that I already messaged him, this is just to keep things professional and chartered.

Copilot

Absolutely, Hasan. Here's a polished and professional email that aligns with the tone of the original message and respectfully communicates your reasons:

Subject: Working from Home – Thursday Request
Hi [Manager's Name],
Following up on my earlier message, I'd like to formally request to work from home this Thursday.
There are no in-person meetings or collaborative tasks scheduled that require me to be on-site, and I'm confident I can complete my work effectively from home. Additionally, given the travel costs involved and the fact that I have no other commitments requiring me to be out, working remotely would be the more practical option for the day.
Please let me know if you're happy to authorise this, and I'll update my Outlook calendar accordingly.
Best regards,
Hasan

Let me know if you'd like to adjust the tone slightly—more casual or more formal—or if you want to include specific tasks you'll be working on that day.

You

(Now Thursday, Sep 4)
How can I write another one for the same reasons for next Tuesday?

Copilot

Here's a polished version you can use for next Tuesday, keeping the tone consistent and professional:

Subject: Working from Home – Tuesday Request
Hi [Manager's Name],
I'd like to request to work from home next Tuesday.
As with Thursday, there are no in-person meetings or collaborative requirements that would necessitate being in the office, and I believe I can work more efficiently from home. It also helps reduce travel costs, and I don't have any other commitments that require me to be out that day.
Please let me know if you're happy to authorise this, and I'll update my calendar accordingly.
Best regards,
Hasan

If you'd like to combine both requests into one email or add a note about what you'll be working on, I can help with that too.

You

(Now Tuesday, Sep 9)
How can I send an email based on this email conversation [Uploaded Document Expired] to finance about the issue and to explain why the spreadsheet changes have been approved?

Copilot

Here's a clear and professional email you can send to the finance team to explain the issue and justify the spreadsheet changes:

Subject: Spend Panel Issue – Spreadsheet Updates and Approval Context

Hi [Finance Team / specific name if known],

I'm writing to provide an update regarding the recent issue raised by Juliet Alika concerning the Spend Panel submission process.

After investigating with the App Support Team, we identified that the error stemmed from inconsistencies between the Team/Unit names listed in the submission form and those in the associated spreadsheet. Specifically, the Excel Connector was unable to match abbreviated or slightly altered names, which caused the flow to fail and prevented requests from reaching the budget manager.

To resolve this, I reviewed the spreadsheet and made updates to the Team/Unit names to ensure consistency with the form inputs. **No changes were made to budget manager names**, in line with the guidance from Denise Wilson that such edits must be confirmed by finance.

These changes have now been implemented in the live version following access approval from James Hobson. The flow has since resumed functioning correctly, and Juliet's request is now processing as expected.

Please let me know if you'd like a summary of the specific edits made or if any further validation is required from your side.

Best regards,
Hasan Akhtar
Email: Hasan.Akhtar@bradfordcft.org.uk
Mobile: 07359 054199
Work Phone: 07483 442954

Would you like to attach a screenshot or list of the updated rows for reference? I can help you draft that too.

You

Based on the information in the email conversation, how can I structure a guide explaining the problem, how it was resolved and advising any application support workers how to fix it if a similar issue occurs in future?

Copilot

Here's a structured guide you can use to document the issue, resolution, and future advice for Application Support workers. It's designed to be clear, actionable, and easy to integrate into internal documentation or onboarding materials.

🛠 Spend Panel Issue Resolution Guide

📌 Overview

This guide outlines a recurring issue with the Spend Panel submission process, explains how it was diagnosed and resolved, and provides steps for Application Support staff to follow if similar problems arise.

⚠ Problem Summary

- **Issue:** Spend requests were failing to reach budget managers despite successful form submission.
- **Reported by:** Juliet Alika
- **Symptoms:**
  - No email confirmation sent to requester
  - No approval flow triggered
  - Multiple failed submissions despite correct cost code and budget manager selection
- **Root Cause:**
  The Excel Connector used in the flow could not match **Team/Unit names** between the form and the spreadsheet due to inconsistent naming (e.g., abbreviations or formatting differences).

☑ Resolution Steps

1. **Error Identification:**
   - Checked flow run history and identified failures linked to specific Team/Unit names (e.g., "Placement Coordination").
   - Verified that the form input and spreadsheet entries did not match exactly.
2. **Spreadsheet Audit:**
   - Reviewed the "List of Budget Managers" spreadsheet for inconsistencies.
   - Identified and documented rows with mismatched Team/Unit names.

3. **Access Coordination:**
    - Requested edit access to the live spreadsheet via SharePoint.
    - Access granted by James Hobson after confirmation from Denise Wilson.
4. **Live Fix:**
    - Updated Team/Unit names in the spreadsheet to match form inputs.
    - **No changes were made to budget manager names**, per finance policy.
5. **Validation:**
    - Re-tested the flow with corrected data.
    - Confirmed successful submission and routing to budget manager.

Future Guidance for Application Support

Diagnosing Similar Issues

- Always check the **run history** of the flow for failed entries.
- Look for mismatches between **form inputs** and **spreadsheet data**, especially:
    - Team/Unit names
    - Formatting (extra spaces, abbreviations, punctuation)

Fixing the Spreadsheet

- Only update **Team/Unit names** to ensure consistency.
- **Do not edit budget manager names** unless explicitly approved by finance.
- Document all changes and notify relevant stakeholders.

Access Management

- If you lack edit access, escalate to the SharePoint owners (e.g., James Hobson).
- Confirm access before making live changes.

Communication

- Inform the requester once the issue is resolved.
- Notify finance and App Support leads of any structural changes to the spreadsheet.

Suggested Additions to Internal Documentation

- Screenshot examples of mismatched vs. corrected entries
- Template for requesting SharePoint access
- Checklist for validating Spend Panel flow integrity

Would you like help turning this into a branded internal PDF or adding visual metaphors for training materials? I can help make it even more engaging.

Conversation by Fifa Utuber with Copilot on Thursday, Aug 14 2025